Pupil studio resources & worksheet — The local canvas: architectural line and form

Pathway: TRACK · Week 1 Part 2 · Big question: How can we use structural line, negative space, and surface frottage to record built architecture?

Arrival check

Look at the bridge truss photo card. Instead of looking at the metal bars, look at the sky gaps between them. What shapes are the gaps?

[ ] Sharp right-angled and isosceles triangles

[ ] Arched window cut-outs

[ ] Repeating diamond spaces

Starter visual cues

Solid structure: vertical towers, horizontal deck, and diagonal cross-bracing.

Negative space: shaded sky triangles trapped inside the framework.

Line weight: heavy dark lines on near beams, lighter lines on distant girders.

Surface ground: subtle graphite frottage texture underneath the line drawing.

Vote: Why do architectural illustrators often draw the empty 'negative space' shapes between beams first?

Studio practice planner

Select your structural focus, texture ground, and line-weight strategy.

Shapes/Focus: Triangulated truss bridge, Twin suspension towers, Arched steel viaduct, Cantilever crane frame

Tools/Methods: Woven mesh frottage, Corrugated ridge rub, 3-level fineliner weight, 4B graphite + white chalk

Exit ticket

What do we call the open sky shapes trapped between the solid beams of a structure?

[ ] Negative space

[ ] Dry brushing

[ ] Colour wheel